Chabad House none of the authorities involved stopped the television media from broadcasting the assault live. This was despite the fact that the NSG, intelligence agencies and Mumbai police all knew that the terrorists were in contact with Lashkar handlers who were watching Indian television and relaying operationally useful information. When an Indian air force helicopter air-dropped NSG commandos on the roof of the Chabad House, the terrorists inside were ready for it. They waited patiently on the fourth floor and opened fire as the commandos descended, killing one of them.[59]

Yet, as confused as the Indian counter-terrorism response was, the investigative pieces of this savage puzzle fell quickly into place. Despite the communications claiming credit on behalf of the Deccan Mujahideen, the attacks had all the hallmarks of a Lashkar operation. Even as many Western pundits reflexively pointed the finger at al-Qaeda during the first days of the attacks, Indian investigators were compiling a strong case against Lashkar. Evidence came to light over a period of time, but it did not take long before India could credibly claim that the attacks originated on Pakistani soil and that Lashkar was the most likely culprit. A thoroughly pre-planned attack would have required no contact, but Lashkar's leaders may have foreseen the need to provide guidance and encouragement to the fidayeen. The group has a history of using electronic communications to increase command-and-control, stretching back to the 1990s when commanders in Pakistan directed foot soldiers in their attacks on security forces in Indian-administered Kashmir. Lashkar's leadership may have wagered that the benefits of maintaining contact with the fidayeen, some of who did waver once in the midst of battle, outweighed the potential costs. Lashkar handlers in Pakistan were speaking with the fidayeen via a VoIP (Voice over Internet Protocol) service, which uses the internet as a medium of communication and is difficult to trace. However, Indian intelligence was able to lock onto the VoIP number, at which point they could listen to all of the calls being made. Some 284 calls were recorded totaling almost 1,000 minutes of conversation among Lashkar's handlers and the terrorists at the Taj, Trident-Oberoi and Chabad House.[60] Within hours of the attacks' commencement, those listening heard one of the Lashkar fidayeen describe how they failed to scuttle the MV *Kuber*.[61] The coast guard found the abandoned trawler the next morning, and with it a wealth of information including the forgotten satellite phone, which contained contact numbers for several Lashkar leaders.[62]